

STARTER TEMPLATE · ADAPT BEFORE ADOPTION

Board / Leadership Briefing Checklist

What to put in front of your board before, during, and after AI rollout.
Twelve items, three categories.

WHO IT IS FOR

C-suite preparing AI briefings for board or executive committee

FILL TIME

5 min

WHAT'S INSIDE

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SECTION 01

The board's job, in one sentence

The board does not need an AI tutorial. It needs to approve four things — scope, the data line, an accountable owner, and one funded pilot — and then see evidence next quarter. Run the briefing as four decisions, not a status update.

SECTION 02

Open with where you stand (2 minutes)

Ground the room before asking for decisions. Four facts, one sentence each:

- ^a Readiness — name a number: “Our AI readiness score is [X/48]; the biggest gap is [governance / data handling].” A named baseline makes next quarter’s progress measurable.
- ^a Peers — one sourced comparison: “Most institutions our size still have no AI governance framework (Jack Henry / Gartner, 2025) — moving now is a lead, not a risk.”
- ^a Regulators — name who applies: SR 11-7 (model risk), Interagency TPRM (vendors), ECOA / Reg B (lending), BSA/AML, and the AIEOG AI Lexicon vocabulary (Feb 2026).
- ^a Already approved — what the board has signed that touches AI: tech budget, vendor list, risk-appetite statement. Build on the record; don’t reopen it.

SECTION 03

The four motions to approve (with recommended defaults)

Bring these as motions with a recommended position, not open questions. The defaults are the lowest-risk, examiner-defensible starting envelope — adjust to your institution.

- ^a Scope — Recommended: approve AI for internal drafting, research, and summarization bank-wide; keep customer-facing and credit-decision use cases explicitly out of scope pending dedicated review. Why: highest value, lowest regulatory exposure to start.
- ^a Data line — Recommended motion (adopt verbatim): “No customer NPI, account, or examination data may be entered into any public AI tool. Confidential institution data is permitted only in [approved enterprise tool] under the signed data-processing agreement.”
- ^a Owner — Recommended: designate one accountable executive (typically CISO or COO) to own the AI use-case inventory and report to the board quarterly. Why: a single named owner is the first thing examiners look for — “the committee” is not an owner.
- ^a Investment — Recommended: fund one pilot — one department, one use case, one success metric — this cycle; defer broad rollout until the pilot clears human review. Why: structured pilots beat bank-wide licenses with no training.

SECTION 04

Copy-paste: the one-page board memo

Drop this into your board packet and fill the brackets. Five lines is enough for most community-institution boards.

1. Position: “[Institution] is adopting AI deliberately. Today we use it for [internal drafting / research]; we do not use it for [credit decisions / customer messaging].”
2. Decision requested: approve the four motions above — scope, data line, owner, investment.
3. Risk posture: “All AI output is draft work; a named human reviews anything that reaches a customer, examiner, or regulated process (human-in-the-loop).”
4. Oversight: “[Owner] maintains the AI use-case inventory and reports quarterly — tools in use, incidents, training completion, and progress against our readiness baseline.”
5. The ask: a motion to adopt the AI Use Policy and authorize the funded pilot.

SECTION 05

What to bring back next quarter (evidence)

Tell the board now what you will show them next time, so oversight is a habit, not a fire drill.

- a The AI use-case inventory — what we run, who owns each, its risk tier. Example row: “Loan-memo drafting · Owner: VP Lending · Tool: [enterprise] · Data: internal only · Tier: medium · HITL: yes.”
- a Incident log — anything flagged since the last briefing (even “none” demonstrates you are watching).
- a Exam readiness — what we could show an examiner today: policy, inventory, vendor reviews, training records.
- a Scorecard vs. the readiness baseline — what moved, what didn’t, and why.

SECTION 06

What good looks like — and the three mistakes to avoid

A strong AI board decision is specific. Watch for these failure patterns:

- a Don’t approve “explore AI” with no scope — that is the decision examiners read as “no governance.”
- a Don’t leave the owner as a committee — name a person, with quarterly reporting.
- a Don’t skip the data line — staff pasting customer data into public tools is the highest-risk gap; the board should prohibit it in writing.

SOURCE BASIS

- GAO 25-107197 — no comprehensive AI-specific banking framework yet
- AIEOG AI Lexicon — AI governance, AI use case inventory
- Bank Director 2024 Technology Survey (via Jack Henry)

ADAPT BEFORE ADOPTION

This is a starter template, not legal advice or an examiner-approved policy. Replace every [bracketed] placeholder, align the language with your institution’s policies, and route the final document through compliance, risk, and legal review.